forever is the sweetest con

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/57579319.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Minor Characters

Additional Tags:
Lesbian Catra (She-Ra), Lesbian Adora (She-Ra), Song: cowboy like me (Taylor Swift), One Shot, Con Artists, Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, I'm Bad At Tagging, I Was Drunk When I Wrote This, Denial of Feelings

Language:
English

Stats:
Published: 2024-07-22 Words: 1,368 Chapters: 1/1

forever is the sweetest con

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/57579319.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Minor Characters

Additional Tags:
Lesbian Catra (She-Ra), Lesbian Adora (She-Ra), Song: cowboy like me (Taylor Swift), One Shot, Con Artists, Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, I'm Bad At Tagging, I Was Drunk When I Wrote This, Denial of Feelings

Language:
English

Stats:
Published: 2024-07-22 Words: 1,368 Chapters: 1/1

forever is the sweetest con

by deathbylesbianism

Summary

Just as she thought about it, she looked over her shoulder and met that blonde's bright blue eyes. It was brief and she swiftly looked away. But there was something in that gaze, something she recognized from years of searching dive bars for that exact look in a rich man's face. Catra smiled to herself; she wasn't exactly on-the-clock that night, but the opportunity was practically begging to be seized. And such a pretty opportunity too. It would be so impolite to turn it down, it would.

So impolite.

-*-

or, Catra is a swindler who ends up falling for this gorgeous blonde woman who also happens to be a swindler. inspired by cowboy like me.

Notes

this has been sitting in my google docs since 2021 and i decided to finish it today because i drank some wine (i need this ok im sick and it makes me absolutely miserable). im not really active on the she-ra fandom anymore but i really wanted to post this one because i really enjoyed writing it. also cowboy like me is my favorite taylor song and i might still be a little tipsy! fun times
anyways, enjoy!

See the end of the work for more notes

“Whisky. Neat, please."

Catra leaned against the bar, feeling the weight of the evening settle over her. The bartender nodded and quickly set about preparing her drink, while she let her gaze drift over the venue. The tennis court, part of the bride’s obscenely rich family estate, was covered up with some kind of tent illuminated by several lanterns and fairy lights. It felt oddly homely. Humble. Quite unusual for the Brightmoon Inc. heir's wedding. But, Catra guessed, it could’ve been the groom’s idea to make it simpler. He looked like the down-to-earth kind of guy you just feel at home with, wherever you are. Sparkles (or whatever her name was) was really lucky to find a guy like that.

The bartender placed her drink in front of her and Catra took a slow sip, savoring the burn as the liquor warmed her insides just right. The bar was a refuge from the festivities, a place where she could observe the mingling guests and without being noticed. Scorpia had dragged her here, insisting she needed to “get out more" or something like that. Catra scoffed at the thought. She wasn't there to socialize. She was there because Scorpia had asked, and that was enough.

Although, a wedding party with several rich, gullible old people was quite an opportunity. And Catra wasn’t stupid; Lord knows she could use the money. She wasn’t exactly proud of being a con artist — she actually wanted to be a journalist before she realized that college was a privilege she just couldn’t afford —, but a job is a job. Anything that pays the bills at the end of the day. And getting to trick gross men while emptying their pockets was pretty satisfactory.

Her eyes roamed the crowd, catching snippets of laughter and conversations that felt worlds away from her reality. She noticed the newlyweds, Sparkles and Bow, glowing with happiness as they moved through the sea of guests. They stopped at the edge of the makeshift dance floor, happily chatting with a tall, blonde woman that seemed to be the very embodiment of the fairy lights

that twinkled around her. Catra recalled seeing that woman at the ceremony as the maid of honor. She also recalled thinking she was pretty, but she kept shrugging it off. If she couldn’t afford rent, she couldn’t afford letting her guard down. Not when her main source of income was on the line.

Catra sighed, taking another sip of her whisky. It took her a while, but she had perfected the art of charming and manipulating rich people — especially men; all it took was one deliberate look for them to think she was interested. Women, on the other hand, were much more difficult to pull a fast one on. Catra wasn't one to discriminate when it came to her targets (if it pays her bills, it's enough), but that was one of the reasons why she rarely targeted women in her schemes. Another major reason was the fact that she was very much a lesbian, and love and work didn’t exactly mix very well for her. It never did and it never would.

Romantic relationships in general had always been a tricky terrain for her to navigate. The closest thing she had to that was her job, but there was no real interest there other than money. Deep down, she craved something real, yet the struggle to actually have an intimate connection with a woman haunted her. It wasn’t a lack of trying, though; Scorpia always tried to set her up with a gym friend or someone from her office, but it always ended before it could even start.

The irony wasn’t lost on her — she could easily play the role of a seductress, yet genuine affection seemed perpetually out of reach. Catra supposed it was for the best. She shouldn’t distract herself.

Just as she thought about it, she looked over her shoulder and met that blonde’s bright blue eyes. It was brief and she swiftly looked away. But there was something in that gaze, something she recognized from years of searching dive bars for that exact look in a rich man’s face. Catra smiled to herself; she wasn’t exactly on-the-clock that night, but the opportunity was practically begging to be seized. And such a pretty opportunity too. It would be so impolite to turn it down, it would.

So impolite.

The blonde woman was still staring, Catra could tell. She lived off this kind of attention, after all. She sipped her whiskey carefully, her crimson lips lingering just a little more than they should on the glass. And she didn't have to wait too much until she heard the rustling of a dress behind her.

"One bourbon, please." *Bingo.*

Catra glanced at her left. The blonde was even more striking up close, with her golden hair cascading down her shoulders and ice blue eyes. She was athletic, probably a gym rat, and the rosé bridesmaid dress accentuated her curves and back muscles just right. As she took a sip of her drink, she directed a warm smile toward Catra, who responded with a polite, if somewhat detached, grin.

"Having fun?" The blonde asked. Her soft southern drawl was quite charming, if Catra was completely honest.

"Yeah," the brunette replied, lightly drumming her manicured fingers on the wooden bar. An unusual and seemingly harmless trick, but oddly effective (especially with women, although it wasn't that hard to imagine why). Catra wouldn't fix what wasn't broken, that's for sure. "Could be better though."

"Hm?"

"I barely know anyone here. Came with a friend."

"Oh." The blonde stirred her drink absentmindedly, subtly averting her gaze. If Catra wasn't so attentive of the nuances of her usual targets, she might have missed it. "So you're not from here, huh?"

"Nope."

"Me neither."

"Hm."

The silence that followed after had that build up tension, the one that always made Catra want to crawl out of her skin and run away. Except this time was different. It was sweet and addictive, and her heart was beating fast out of excitement rather than anxiety. She couldn't help but grin.

"What is a pretty girl like you doing, huh?" She sipped her drink, her voice low and hoarse from the alcohol. "Drinking alone at your best friend's wedding?"

Blondie's smile was shy, but not earnest. "Not really my scene, y'know? Parties, I mean."

"Huh," the brunette mused, a smirk slowly forming on her crimson red lips. She could smell the bullshit behind that shy-and-lonely facade from miles away. She used that one several times before it got too old and boring, but it was rather endearing coming from someone else that beautiful. Takes one to know one. "You seem to be enjoying it quite a bit, actually."

The other woman smiled sweetly, although the gleam of amusement in her sky-blue eyes gave away that it was more of a playful teasing than genuine kindness. "I would enjoy it more if you danced with me."

Catra felt her cheeks flush slightly, against her better judgment. She cleared her throat, keeping her composure, and downed the rest of her whisky in one swift motion. "You know, princess, dancing is a dangerous game."

Blondie laughed. That honey sweet, hearty kind of laughter one would do anything to hear again. The kind of laughter Catra had been avoiding for so long, too long even. But it was too late, and Blondie was holding her hand and the two of them were going to the makeshift dance floor together. It was too late, and they were swaying along to some country song they probably had heard before and they were so, so close. It was too late, and then suddenly Catra knew that their bodies fit perfectly together like pieces of a puzzle and what *Adora's* lips tasted like. Bourbon,

cherry lip gloss, and home. It was too late, and she knew that this was going to be one of *those* things; that she would regret this moment as soon as she woke up because it made her hopelessly and earnestly yearn for more of what she couldn't have. It was too late.

I'm never gonna love again.

End Notes

as always, kudos and comments are appreciated. thanks for reading :)

also argentinian merlot is really good guys like fr top 10 best wines ive ever had

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!